

25STCV07466 25STCV07466

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 309

Hearing date: 2026-07-14

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Case Number: 25STCV07466 Hearing Date: July 14, 2026 Dept: 309

Superior Court of California

County of Los Angeles

DEPARTMENT

17

TENTATIVE RULING

CLAUDIA RANGEL

vs.

AMERICAN HONDA

MOTOR CO., INC.

Case

No.: 25STCV07466

Hearing Date: July 14, 2026

Larry Chae's

motion to be relieved as counsel is DENIED.

Legal Standard

Motions to withdraw are routinely

granted if made in the proper form and presented with proper notice. The court

may issue an order allowing an attorney to withdraw from representation, after notice to the client. (Code Civ. Proc., § 284(2).)

Discussion

Larry Chae

brings a motion for relief as counsel as to Plaintiff Claudia Rangel.

The following documents are properly submitted: Civil Form MC-051 "Notice of Motion and Motion to be Relieved as Counsel," Civil Form MC-052 "Declaration in Support of Attorney's Motion to be Relieved as Counsel," and Civil Form MC-053 "Order Granting Attorney's Motion to be Relieved as Counsel."

However,

Mr. Chae's motion comes 6 days before trial is set to begin. In his declaration supporting this motion, Mr. Chae indicates that Plaintiff has been non-communicative about key updates regarding her case, and failed to respond to a comprehensive letter sent 1/27/2026. However, counsel offers no explanation as to why he did not move to be relieved until 5/14/2026, nor does he explain why he did not seek ex parte relief to accelerate the motion to allow Plaintiff to obtain replacement counsel in time for trial. In light of the prejudice that would result by relieving counsel, the request must be denied.

The

motion is DENIED.

It is so ordered.

Dated: July
, 2026

Hon. Jon R.
Takasugi

Judge of the
Superior Court

Parties who intend to submit on this tentative must

send an email to the court at
by 4 p.m. the day prior as directed by the instructions provided on the court
website at www.lacourt.org. If a party submits
on the tentative, the party's email must include the case number and must
identify the party submitting on the tentative.
If all parties to a motion submit, the court will adopt this
tentative as the final order. If the department
does not receive an email indicating the parties are submitting on the
tentative and there are no appearances at the hearing, the motion may be placed
off calendar. For more information, please contact the court clerk at (213)
633-0517.